ROALLA



EXECUTIVE APPLICATION PORTFOLIO DECISION GUIDE

Application Portfolio Rationalization

Decide what to retain modernize consolidate replace or retire using consistent evidence

Prepared for chief executives, finance, operations, technology, procurement, risk, human resources and transformation leaders

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Purpose

This guide helps management turn an incomplete application list into an evidence-based portfolio. It evaluates business value, user fit, technical health, cost, risk, dependencies and change readiness so each application receives a deliberate retain, modernize, consolidate, replace or retire decision.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

Rationalization is not a licence-cutting exercise or a cloud migration list. Management needs one portfolio model that connects business capabilities, applications, data, integrations, cost, risk and accountable target-state decisions.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Is the configuration management database enough?	**NO**	Technical records rarely contain business value, user experience, cost and disposition evidence.
Should cloud migration be the default answer?	**NO**	Select treatment from business and technical evidence, not destination preference.
Can duplicate applications be removed immediately?	**CONDITIONAL**	Dependencies, data, process variation and adoption must be resolved first.
Does go-live complete rationalization?	**NO**	Value is realized only when legacy cost, risk and complexity are retired.
What should management authorize now?	**PURSUE**	A fact-based portfolio baseline and decision wave for priority applications.

Recommended Management Posture

Use the decision model to convert management confidence into verified evidence, explicit ownership and sequenced action. A weighted score supports prioritization, but a material hard-gate failure should override an attractive average.

Questions to Put to the Leadership Team

1. Can we identify every material application and accountable owner?
2. Which applications are critical, differentiating, tolerated or no longer needed?
3. Where does poor user experience create workarounds or shadow systems?
4. Which applications carry unsupported technology or concentrated knowledge?
5. What does each application cost after labour, integration and support are included?
6. Which data and interfaces prevent retirement or consolidation?
7. What evidence supports each retain, modernize, replace or retire decision?
8. When will legacy cost and risk actually leave the organization?

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Portfolio Decision Gates

These gates convert a broad executive ambition into explicit evidence, accountable decisions and a sequenced operating plan.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Inventory	Applications and ownership are complete	Application, owner, capability, users, cost, lifecycle and environment
02	Value	Business contribution is understood	Criticality, differentiation, satisfaction, demand and future need
03	Health	Technical condition is evidenced	Architecture, debt, supportability, reliability, performance and skills
04	Risk	Security and compliance exposure is visible	Vulnerabilities, data, access, resilience, vendor and audit findings
05	Economics	Full run and change cost are credible	Licences, infrastructure, labour, support, integration and exit cost
06	Dependency	Connections and migration constraints are mapped	Data, interfaces, processes, users, vendors and downstream services
07	Disposition	A deliberate treatment is selected	Retain, retire, replace, rehost, replatform, refactor or rearchitect
08	Execution	The roadmap protects operations and realizes value	Waves, funding, owners, adoption, decommission and benefits

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT MODEL

Readiness Dimensions

No.	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Portfolio completeness	Applications, owners, capabilities, users, lifecycle and environment	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
02	Business value	Criticality, differentiation, satisfaction, demand and strategic fit	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
03	Technical health	Architecture, debt, reliability, supportability, performance and skills	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
04	Risk and compliance	Security, data, access, resilience, vendor and regulatory exposure	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
05	Economics	Full cost, unit cost, change cost, commitments and exit economics	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
06	Disposition and execution	Target treatment, dependencies, waves, decommission and benefits	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Inventory	Applications and ownership are complete	Application, owner, capability, users, cost, lifecycle and environment
Value	Business contribution is understood	Criticality, differentiation, satisfaction, demand and future need
Health	Technical condition is evidenced	Architecture, debt, supportability, reliability, performance and skills
Risk	Security and compliance exposure is visible	Vulnerabilities, data, access, resilience, vendor and audit findings
Economics	Full run and change cost are credible	Licences, infrastructure, labour, support, integration and exit cost
Dependency	Connections and migration constraints are mapped	Data, interfaces, processes, users, vendors and downstream services
Disposition	A deliberate treatment is selected	Retain, retire, replace, rehost, replatform, refactor or rearchitect
Execution	The roadmap protects operations and realizes value	Waves, funding, owners, adoption, decommission and benefits

ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Portfolio Evidence and Decision Readiness

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	One inventory includes custom, commercial, SaaS, low-code, departmental and shadow applications.	☐	☐	_____
A02	Every application has an accountable business owner and technical owner.	☐	☐	_____
A03	Applications are mapped to business capabilities, processes, users and critical services.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Current and future business value is rated using consistent evidence.	☐	☐	_____
A05	User satisfaction, adoption, support burden and workflow fit are measured.	☐	☐	_____
A06	Technical health covers architecture, debt, reliability, performance, supportability and skills.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Security, privacy, data, resilience and regulatory risks are assessed.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Total cost includes licences, hosting, labour, support, integration, facilities and vendors.	☐	☐	_____
A09	Data, interfaces, reports, automations and downstream dependencies are mapped.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Contract dates, end-of-support, vendor viability and key-person dependencies are visible.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

Disposition Roadmap and Decommission Controls

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	Each application has a documented retain, retire, replace, rehost, replatform, refactor or rearchitect decision.	☐	☐	_____
B02	Disposition decisions include business value, health, risk, economics and dependency evidence.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Capability consolidation resolves process variation and requirements before tool selection.	☐	☐	_____
B04	Target-state architecture identifies authoritative platforms, data and integration patterns.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Migration waves consider operational calendars, capacity, risk and prerequisite decisions.	☐	☐	_____
B06	Business cases include transition cost, dual-running, data migration, adoption and decommission work.	☐	☐	_____
B07	Data archive, retention, legal hold, access and disposal requirements are approved.	☐	☐	_____
B08	Legacy interfaces, accounts, licences, infrastructure and support agreements have closure tasks.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Benefits are measured after actual retirement rather than target-platform go-live.	☐	☐	_____
B10	Portfolio governance reviews new demand and prevents complexity from returning.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Portfolio completeness	20%	Applications, owners, capabilities, users, lifecycle and environment	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Business value	20%	Criticality, differentiation, satisfaction, demand and strategic fit	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Technical health	15%	Architecture, debt, reliability, supportability, performance and skills	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Risk and compliance	15%	Security, data, access, resilience, vendor and regulatory exposure	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Economics	15%	Full cost, unit cost, change cost, commitments and exit economics	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Disposition and execution	15%	Target treatment, dependencies, waves, decommission and benefits	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	**PURSUE**	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	**PREPARE**	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	**MONITOR**	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Build a credible portfolio and decision model first, then prove it on a focused wave that includes actual decommissioning.



Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Inventory	Reconcile applications, owners, capabilities, costs, lifecycle and known risk.	Portfolio baseline
Days 16 to 35	Assess	Score business value, user fit, technical health, risk, economics and dependencies.	Evidence heatmap
Days 36 to 55	Decide	Assign target dispositions and identify target-state and prerequisite decisions.	Disposition portfolio
Days 56 to 75	Sequence	Build waves, business cases, migration, adoption and decommission plans.	Execution roadmap
Days 76 to 90	Mobilize	Launch one priority wave and install portfolio governance and benefit tracking.	Governed program

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: establish the portfolio baseline and approve the first disposition wave.
- Quarter 2: execute consolidation and modernization with explicit legacy closure plans.
- Quarters 3 and 4: extend rationalization across capabilities and integrate financial and risk planning.
- Year 2: operate continuous application portfolio governance and prevent renewed sprawl.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA combines business architecture, application and data architecture, cost, risk, vendor, adoption and execution evidence into defensible portfolio decisions.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Portfolio diagnostic	Create the inventory, ownership and evidence model.
Capability mapping	Connect applications to business processes, users and strategic needs.
Health and risk assessment	Evaluate architecture, debt, supportability, security, data and resilience.
Economic analysis	Build credible run, change, transition and exit cost views.
Disposition facilitation	Lead consistent retain, modernize, consolidate, replace and retire decisions.
Target-state architecture	Define authoritative platforms, data and integration patterns.
Roadmap and business cases	Sequence waves, dependencies, funding, adoption and benefits.
Portfolio governance	Create intake, standards, lifecycle review and complexity controls.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week application portfolio rationalization diagnostic.
- Business value, health, risk and economics scorecard.
- Disposition decisions for one priority capability or portfolio segment.
- 90-day execution roadmap with decommission and benefit controls.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Inventory illusion	The portfolio excludes SaaS, low-code and shadow applications.	Reconcile identity, finance, integration and business sources.
Technical-only scoring	Business value and user needs are ignored.	Use joint business and technology evidence.
Cloud default	Workloads move without reducing cost or complexity.	Select treatment application by application.
Dependency surprise	Retirement breaks data, reports or downstream processes.	Map dependencies and validate consumers.
Dual-running drift	Legacy platforms remain after replacement.	Fund and govern decommission explicitly.
Data abandonment	Records are lost or retained without control.	Approve archive, access, retention and disposal.
Change overload	Too many migrations exceed business capacity.	Sequence waves against operational constraints.
Sprawl returns	New tools bypass portfolio decisions.	Install intake, architecture and lifecycle governance.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

Microsoft Cloud Migration Rationalization Strategies. Official source — Decision guidance covering retire, retain, rehost, replatform, refactor, rearchitect, rebuild and replace options.

Microsoft Cloud Modernization Planning. Official source — Guidance for sequencing modernization according to business value, technical need, risk and delivery capacity.

FinOps Foundation Usage Optimization Capability. Official source — A cross-technology approach to matching resources and services to actual demand while protecting performance and resilience.

NIST Cybersecurity Framework 2.0. Official source — A risk-based framework covering governance, identification, protection, detection, response and recovery, including supply-chain risk.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.